

2010 **SOLAR IMPULSE**

Taking off from Payerne Air Base in Switzerland, *Solar Impulse* became the first solar-powered aircraft to complete a nonstop flight lasting for more than 24 hours. It traveled 26 hours in total before landing back where it started. The flight was the longest and, at a maximum altitude of 28,543 ft (8,700 m), the highest made by a manned solar aircraft.



Solar Impulse in flight



André Borschberg

In 2015, Borschberg, a co-founder of the Solar Impulse project, made a nonstop flight of 117 hours and 52 minutes in *Solar Impulse 2*, the next craft in the series.

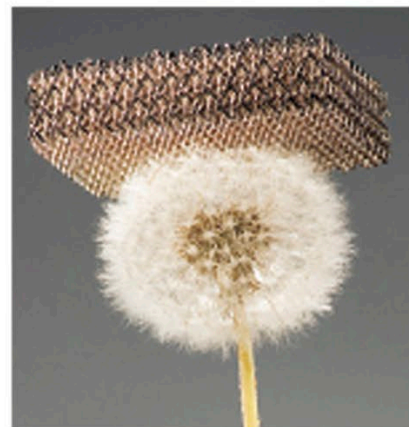
“The structure is so fine that it is 99.99 percent air.”

Tobias Schaedler (of HRL Laboratories),
on microlattice, November 2011

2011

Ultra-light material

An American company called HRL Laboratories produced the world's first metallic microlattice material. An alloy of the metals phosphorus and nickel, it consists of a network of hollow struts that interconnect with each other. It is so light that a 4-in (10-cm) square cube of the material weighs less than 0.035 oz (1 g) and may become a valuable material in aerospace.



2010

2010

iPad launched

Apple's first tablet computer, the iPad, went on sale. The original iPad had no camera, but subsequent models featured front and rear-facing cameras able to take still photos and video footage. More than 300 million iPads have since been sold.

A connected world
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2010

Jetpack debuts

In 2010, a prototype of Martin Aircraft's Jetpack went on sale. The world's first personal vertical take-off and landing (VTOL) craft, the Jetpack does not use a jet engine. Instead, a gasoline-fueled, 200-horsepower engine spins two ducted fans to lift a person to heights of more than 7,546 ft (2,300 m).



In 2011, IBM's Watson supercomputer defeated two human contestants on the Jeopardy! quiz show.